

CLAT Express - February 2026: Study Notes

Chapters, topics and sub-topics with key facts, memory aids and mind-map outlines.

International Relations and News

US Supreme Court Blocks Trump's IEEPA Tariffs

IEEPA: Origin and Emergency Powers

The International Emergency Economic Powers Act (IEEPA) was enacted in 1977 by President Jimmy Carter to replace the Trading with Enemy Act of 1917. It is primarily a sanctions tool and not a general tariff law. The President can use it only after formally declaring a National Emergency over an unusual and extraordinary threat originating outside the United States.

- Enacted in 1977 by President Jimmy Carter
- Replaced the Trading with Enemy Act (1917)
- Primarily a sanctions tool, not a general tariff law
- President must formally declare a National Emergency first
- Threat must originate outside the United States
- Can freeze foreign assets held in the US
- Can block trade with specific countries, entities or individuals
- 77 national emergencies declared under IEEPA; 46 ongoing as of Sept 2025

Mind-map outline

IEEPA: 1977 emergency economic powers

- Origin
 - Enacted by President Jimmy Carter
 - Replaced Trading with Enemy Act (1917)
- Requirements
 - Formal National Emergency declaration
 - Threat originates outside the US
- Powers
 - Regulate financial transactions
 - Freeze foreign assets in the US
 - Block trade with specific parties

Supreme Court Verdict on IEEPA Tariffs

The Supreme Court struck down President Trump's IEEPA tariffs by a 6-3 verdict. Chief Justice John Roberts held that IEEPA does not allow unilateral tariff actions without Congressional approval. The ruling invalidated the Liberation Day tariffs and raised questions about refunds of tariffs already collected.

- Verdict: 6-3 against Trump's IEEPA tariffs
- Chief Justice John Roberts clarified the Court's reasoning
- 'Regulate' under IEEPA does not mean 'Tax'
- IEEPA cannot serve as broad authority for imposing tariffs
- Any such measures require Congressional authorisation
- Liberation Day tariffs (executive order of 02 April 2025) invalidated
- Ruling raises questions on refunds of previously collected tariffs
- Majority: Roberts, Gorsuch, Barrett, Sotomayor, Kagan, Jackson
- Dissent: Thomas, Alito, Kavanaugh

Mind-map outline

Supreme Court verdict on IEEPA tariffs

- Reasoning
 - 'Regulate' does not mean 'Tax'
 - IEEPA is for emergency restrictions
- Effect
 - Liberation Day tariffs invalidated
 - Refund questions raised

- Majority
 - Roberts, Gorsuch, Barrett
 - Sotomayor, Kagan, Jackson
- Dissent
 - Thomas, Alito, Kavanaugh

Alternative Tariff Laws After the Ruling

The booklet lists several statutes as legal alternatives to IEEPA for imposing tariffs. Section 122 of the Trade Act 1974 allows temporary tariffs, and the President used it to impose a 10% temporary tariff on goods from all countries. Other options are Section 338 of the Tariff Act 1930, Section 232 of the Trade Expansion Act 1962 and Section 301 of the Trade Act 1974.

- Section 122, Trade Act 1974: temporary tariffs up to 15% for up to 150 days
- Section 122 aims to protect domestic industries and address trade imbalances
- 10% temporary tariff imposed on goods from all countries under Section 122
- Section 338, Tariff Act 1930: import tariffs up to 50%
- Section 338 targets countries with discriminatory trade practices
- Section 232, Trade Expansion Act 1962: import restrictions on goods threatening national security
- Section 232 has been applied to steel and aluminium
- Section 301, Trade Act 1974: action against foreign regulations that unfairly burden US trade

Mnemonic - Alternative Laws in Section Order: Temporary Steel Unfair Discriminators

Temporary = Section 122, Trade Act 1974: temporary tariffs up to 15% for up to 150 days; Steel = Section 232, Trade Expansion Act 1962: import restrictions on goods threatening national security, applied to steel and aluminium; Unfair = Section 301, Trade Act 1974: action against foreign regulations that unfairly burden US trade; Discriminators = Section 338, Tariff Act 1930: import tariffs up to 50% on countries with discriminatory trade practices

Mind-map outline

Tariff laws after IEEPA ruling

- Trade Act 1974
 - Section 122: temporary tariffs
 - Section 301: unfair foreign rules
- Tariff Act 1930
 - Section 338: up to 50%
- Trade Expansion Act 1962
 - Section 232: national security

India's Impact and the 2026 Trade Deal

The rollback of Liberation Day tariffs benefits nearly 55% of India's exports to the US, which had faced an 18% levy. These goods now face only standard Most-Favoured Nation (MFN) tariff rates, while Section 232 duties remain in force. The 2026 India-US trade deal includes Indian commitments on energy, technology and agricultural trade.

- Nearly 55% of India's exports to the US benefit from the rollback
- Those goods previously faced an 18% levy
- Benefiting goods are now subject only to standard MFN tariff rates
- Section 232 tariffs of 50% on steel and aluminium remain in force
- 25% Section 232 tariff on select automotive components remains in force
- 25% penalty for purchasing Russian oil has been eliminated
- India commits to massive procurement of US energy, technology and agricultural products
- India aims to remove barriers for US agricultural exports such as cotton and nuts

Mind-map outline

India impact and 2026 deal

- Rollback benefits
 - Nearly 55% of exports
 - Earlier 18% levy
- Duties still apply
 - Steel and aluminium: 50%
 - Select auto components: 25%

- India commitments
 - Buy US energy, technology, agriculture
 - Remove barriers for US farm exports

US Congress and India-US Relations

The US Congress is a bicameral legislature, and the Supreme Court ruling makes Congressional approval necessary for broad tariffs. India-US total trade reached USD 129.2 billion in 2024, with India's exports to the US larger than its imports from the US. The US is India's third largest investor.

- US Congress is bicameral: House of Representatives and Senate
- House has 435 seats; members are elected for 2 years
- Senate has 100 seats; every state has 2 seats
- Senators are elected for 6 years; one-third of Senate seats are up every 2 years
- Republican Party has secured 54 Senate seats
- India-US total trade in 2024: USD 129.2 billion
- India's exports to US in 2024: USD 87.4 billion
- India's imports from US in 2024: USD 41.8 billion
- USA is India's 3rd largest investor, with FDI inflows of USD 65.19 billion (2000-2024)

Mind-map outline

US Congress and India-US ties

- Congress
 - House: 435 seats, 2-year term
 - Senate: 100 seats, 6-year term
- Trade in 2024
 - Total USD 129.2 billion
 - Exports USD 87.4 billion
 - Imports USD 41.8 billion
- Investment
 - US is 3rd largest investor
 - FDI USD 65.19 billion (2000-2024)

End of New START Treaty

New START Expiry and Its Implications

The New START Treaty, the last legally binding nuclear arms control pact between the United States and Russia, expired on 5 February 2026. Its lapse removes binding limits on strategic nuclear arsenals and weakens the verification mechanisms that once made them predictable. Negotiations have stalled as relations deteriorate, and the booklet warns of greater uncertainty, miscalculation and a possible arms race.

- Full name: New Strategic Arms Reduction Treaty (New START).
- Signed in 2010 and came into force in 2011; extended by 5 years in 2021, valid until 05 Feb 2026.
- Caps each country at 1550 operationally deployed strategic nuclear warheads.
- The ceiling covers deployed warheads only, not stockpiled or reserve weapons.
- Russia suspended New START participation in 2023 amid the Ukraine war.
- Russia suspended information-sharing on its nuclear forces; the US accuses Russia of non-compliance.
- Expiry removes binding caps and halts inspections and nuclear data sharing.
- Loss of verification increases opacity and risks eroding global nuclear restraint norms.

Mnemonic - Key New START provisions: Can Doubts Vanish?

C = Ceiling of 1550 deployed strategic warheads per country; D = Delivery limits on ICBMs, SLBMs and heavy bombers; V = Verification through on-site inspections and data exchanges

Mind-map outline

New START Treaty

- Warhead ceiling
 - 1550 deployed warheads per country
 - Stockpiled and reserve weapons not covered
- Delivery system limits

- ICBMs, SLBMs and heavy bombers
- Verification and transparency
 - On-site inspections
 - Data exchanges and notifications

Cold War Arms Control Milestones

Arms control between the United States and the Soviet Union progressed through a series of talks and agreements. The SALT I round produced the Anti-Ballistic Missile (ABM) Treaty, which limited missile defence to preserve mutual vulnerability. Later instruments such as SALT II, START I, START II and SORT set quantitative limits or served as interim pacts, but several were never ratified or were later abandoned.

- SALT I (1969-1972) resulted in the Anti-Ballistic Missile (ABM) Treaty.
- The ABM Treaty restricted deployment of missile defence systems to preserve mutual vulnerability.
- SALT II (1972-1979) set quantitative limits on nuclear delivery systems, including long-range missiles and strategic bombers.
- The United States never ratified SALT II, owing to Soviet military intervention in Afghanistan.
- START I (1991) capped 6000 nuclear warheads, enforced inspections and expired in 2009.
- START II (1993) aimed to reduce nuclear weapons to 3,500; Russia withdrew after the US exited the ABM Treaty.
- SORT (2002), also known as the Moscow Treaty, was an interim agreement between the US and Russia.

Mind-map outline

Arms control milestones

- SALT I (1969-1972)
- SALT II (1972-1979)
- START I (1991)
- START II (1993)
- SORT (2002)

Nuclear Treaties and Control Regimes

Beyond the US-Russia pacts, a set of global treaties and voluntary export-control regimes aims to limit nuclear weapons and their spread. The NPT classifies states as nuclear-weapon or non-nuclear-weapon states, the CTBT seeks to end nuclear testing, and the TPNW bans nuclear weapons outright. Export regimes such as the Australia Group, the MTCR and the Wassenaar Arrangement coordinate controls on sensitive goods.

- Outer Space Treaty (1967) bans deployment of weapons of mass destruction in outer space; all nuclear-armed nations are signatories.
- NPT (1968) aims to prevent nuclear spread and promote disarmament, and classifies nations as nuclear-weapon or non-nuclear-weapon states.
- CTBT (1996) seeks to ban all nuclear weapon testing for civilian and military use.
- CTBT is signed by 185 countries and ratified by 170, but remains non-operational as ratification by key nuclear-armed states is pending.
- TPNW (2017) bans development, testing, possession and use of nuclear weapons.
- Missile Technology Control Regime (1987) is an informal political understanding with 35 members.
- Australia Group (1985) is an informal export control forum formed after chemical weapons use in the Iran-Iraq War.
- Wassenaar Arrangement (1996) is a voluntary export control regime with 42 members.

Mnemonic - Export control regimes: Always Monitor Wisely

A = Australia Group (1985): informal export control forum on chemical and biological weapons; M = Missile Technology Control Regime (1987): informal political understanding; W = Wassenaar Arrangement (1996): voluntary export control regime

Mind-map outline

Global nuclear controls

- Nuclear treaties
 - Outer Space Treaty 1967

- NPT 1968
- CTBT 1996
- TPNW 2017
- Export control regimes
 - Australia Group 1985
 - MTCR 1987
 - Wassenaar Arrangement 1996

India's Nuclear Journey and the IAEA

India's nuclear programme began with the Atomic Energy Commission under Homi J. Bhabha and grew through its reactors and Pokhran tests. Its diplomacy includes a No First Use pledge and a 2008 NSG waiver that enabled nuclear trade despite its non-signatory status to the NPT. The International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA), established in 1957, supports safeguards, nuclear safety and peaceful use worldwide.

- Establishment of the Atomic Energy Commission in 1948 laid the foundation of India's nuclear programme under Homi J. Bhabha.
- The Apsara reactor became operational in 1956 as Asia's first nuclear reactor.
- Tarapur Atomic Power Station began operations in 1969 as India's first commercial nuclear power plant.
- Pokhran-I, 'Smiling Buddha', was conducted on 18 May 1974 at the Pokhran range.
- Pokhran-II in May 1998 comprised three tests on 11 May (codename Shakti-I) and two more on 13 May.
- India's No First Use policy pledges no first nuclear strike but retains the right to retaliate if attacked.
- A 2008 NSG waiver enabled nuclear trade with India despite its non-signatory status to the NPT.
- IAEA, established 1957 and headquartered in Vienna, has 180 members and is led by Director General Rafael Grossi.

Mnemonic - India's milestones in order: A Tiny Buddha Shakes

A = Apsara reactor became operational in 1956; T = Tarapur became India's first commercial nuclear power plant in 1969; B = Pokhran-I 'Smiling Buddha' test on 18 May 1974; S = Pokhran-II Shakti tests in May 1998

Mind-map outline

India's nuclear journey

- Early programme
 - Atomic Energy Commission 1948
 - Apsara reactor 1956
 - Tarapur plant 1969
- Pokhran tests
 - Smiling Buddha 1974
 - Pokhran-II in May 1998
- Diplomacy
 - India-US civil nuclear deal
 - 2008 NSG waiver
 - No First Use policy

Tarique Rahman Becomes Bangladesh's Next PM

Tarique Rahman's Rise and Oath

Tarique Rahman emerged as the top leader of the Bangladesh Nationalist Party (BNP) and assumed office as Prime Minister of Bangladesh. He returned to Bangladesh after 17 years and took the oath at Parliament South Plaza in Dhaka. His government succeeded the overthrown government of Sheikh Hasina after 18 months of upheaval.

- Tarique Rahman emerged as the top leader of the BNP
- Son of former President and BNP founder Ziaur Rahman
- Son of former Prime Minister Khaleda Zia
- Returned to Bangladesh after 17 years
- Took oath as Prime Minister at Parliament South Plaza, Dhaka

- Om Birla attended the swearing-in ceremony
- Succeeded Sheikh Hasina's overthrown government
- Marked a major political shift after 18 months of upheaval

Mind-map outline

Tarique Rahman's Rise

- Leadership
 - Top leader of BNP
 - Son of Ziaur Rahman and Khaleda Zia
- Return
 - Back after 17 years
- Oath
 - Parliament South Plaza, Dhaka
 - Om Birla attended ceremony
- Context
 - Succeeded Hasina's overthrown government
 - After 18 months of upheaval

2026 Election Results and Parliament

The BNP, led by Tarique Rahman, won the 13th General Election with 209 seats, an absolute majority, ending the Awami League's two-decade dominance. Jamaat-e-Islami emerged as the second-largest party with 68 seats. Bangladesh's legislature is unicameral, with 300 members elected directly and 50 seats reserved for women and allocated proportionally among parties.

- BNP won 209 seats, an absolute majority
- Won the 13th General Election
- Ended the Awami League's two-decade dominance
- Jamaat-e-Islami was the second-largest party with 68 seats
- National Citizen Party won 6 seats
- Legislature is unicameral
- 300 members elected directly by first-past-the-post
- 50 seats reserved for women, allocated proportionally among parties

Mnemonic - Seat Split: 300 Vote, 50 Share

300 = Members elected directly by first-past-the-post; 50 = Seats reserved for women, allocated proportionally among parties

Mind-map outline

2026 Election and Parliament

- Seats won
 - BNP: 209 (absolute majority)
 - Jamaat-e-Islami: 68
 - National Citizen Party: 6
- Structure
 - Unicameral legislature
 - 300 elected directly (FPTP)
 - 50 women's seats, proportional

Political Background and Transitions

Bangladesh became independent from Pakistan in 1971, and Sheikh Mujibur Rahman became Prime Minister in 1972. Power then passed through Ziaur Rahman, Khaleda Zia and Sheikh Hasina, and the BNP last governed in 2001-2006. The 2024-2026 interim period followed a student-led revolution and Hasina's flight to India.

- Bangladesh gained independence from Pakistan in 1971
- Sheikh Mujibur Rahman became Prime Minister in 1972
- In 1975, the constitution was amended to form the single party BAKSAL
- Sheikh Mujibur Rahman was assassinated on 15 August 1975
- Ziaur Rahman became President in 1977
- Ziaur Rahman was assassinated on 30 May 1981 in Chittagong
- Khaleda Zia was sworn in as first female PM on 20 March 1991

- Sheikh Hasina was sworn in as PM for the first time on 23 June 1996
- BNP last governed 2001-2006 under Khaleda Zia with Jamaat-e-Islami
- Interim period 2024-2026 followed a student-led revolution

Mind-map outline

Political Transitions

- Early years
 - 1971: independence from Pakistan
 - 1972: Mujibur Rahman becomes PM
- Single-party era
 - 1975: BAKSAL formed
 - Mujibur Rahman assassinated, 15 Aug 1975
- BNP leaders
 - 1977: Ziaur Rahman becomes President
 - 1981: Ziaur assassinated in Chittagong
 - 1991: Khaleda Zia first female PM
- Hasina and BNP turns
 - 1996: Hasina first sworn in as PM
 - 2001-2006: BNP-led government
- Interim period
 - 2024-2026 after student-led revolution
 - Hasina fled to India

July National Charter and PM Power Limits

The July National Charter (Constitutional Amendment) Implementation Order 2025 is a 28-page reform agreement signed by 25 political parties and the interim government led by Muhammad Yunus. It secured 65.3% yes votes in a referendum. It caps a PM's lifetime service at 10 years, bars the PM from holding both party and government head roles, and creates a two-house parliament.

- 28-page constitutional reform agreement
- Signed by 25 political parties and the interim government led by Muhammad Yunus
- Referendum: 65.3% yes votes against a 50%+1 threshold
- First referendum since 1991
- No individual can serve as PM for more than 10 years in a lifetime
- PM cannot be both party head and head of government
- Emergency declaration needs written consent of the cabinet and the leader of the opposition
- Bicameral parliament: 400-seat Lower House and new 100-seat Upper House
- Reserved seats for women in the Lower House increased to 100
- Article 70 to be removed or significantly weakened

Mnemonic - PM Power Limits: TDE: Term, Dual roles, Emergency

T = No individual can serve as PM for more than 10 years in a lifetime; D = PM cannot be both party head and head of government; E = Emergency declaration needs written consent of the cabinet and the opposition leader

Mind-map outline

July National Charter 2025

- Signatories
 - 25 political parties
 - Interim government led by Yunus
 - 28-page agreement
- PM limits
 - 10-year lifetime term cap
 - No dual party and government head
 - Emergency needs cabinet and opposition consent
- Parliament
 - Two houses: Lower House and Senate
 - Lower House: 400 seats
 - Upper House: 100 seats
- Referendum
 - 65.3% yes votes
 - Threshold: 50%+1

- Elections
 - Non-partisan caretaker government
 - Paper ballots; EVMs largely rejected

India-Bangladesh Ties Under the New Government

Ties between India and Bangladesh moved from strained relations in 2001-2006 to a 'Golden Chapter' under Sheikh Hasina from 2009 to 2024. After Hasina's flight to India, anti-India sentiment surged in Bangladesh. The booklet lists security priorities, including the Hasina extradition issue and avoiding drift toward Pakistan or China, alongside trade and connectivity goals.

- 2001-2006: India accused the regime of sheltering ULFA and NDFB
- 2009-2024 'Golden Chapter' under Sheikh Hasina
- Land Boundary Agreement signed in 2015
- Interim period saw anti-India sentiment surge
- Anti-India sentiment linked to perception that India backed an 'Authoritarian Regime'
- Security priority: manage political pressure over Hasina's presence in India
- Security priority: prevent Bangladesh drifting toward Pakistan or China
- Security priority: counter anti-India extremism and insurgency
- Bangladesh is India's biggest trade partner in South Asia
- Trade in FY 2023-24 was US\$14.01 billion

Mind-map outline

India-Bangladesh Ties

- Past phases
 - 2001-2006: strained ties
 - 2009-2024: Golden Chapter
 - Land Boundary Agreement (2015)
- Interim sentiment
 - Anti-India sentiment surged
 - Hasina fled to India
- Security priorities
 - Hasina extradition pressure
 - Avoid drift toward Pakistan or China
 - Counter anti-India extremism
- Economic and civil ties
 - Trade US\$14.01 billion, FY 2023-24
 - Infrastructure continuity
 - Visas for healthcare and tourism

National News and Issues

Manipur Gets Elected Government After President's Rule

New Government in Manipur

President Droupadi Murmu revoked President's Rule in Manipur after nearly one year, clearing the path for an elected government. Yumnam Khemchand Singh (BJP) was sworn in as the 13th Manipur Chief Minister. Two Deputy Chief Ministers, Nemcha Kipgen and Losii Dikho, took oath alongside him.

- President Droupadi Murmu revoked President's Rule in Manipur
- President's Rule in Manipur had lasted nearly one year
- Yumnam Khemchand Singh (BJP) sworn in as 13th Manipur CM
- Nemcha Kipgen: Kuki-Zo MLA from Kangpokpi constituency, Deputy CM
- Losii Dikho: Naga MLA from Mao constituency, Deputy CM
- Revocation cleared the way for an elected government

Mind-map outline

New Government in Manipur

- Chief Minister

- Yumnam Khemchand Singh (BJP)
- Deputy Chief Ministers
 - Nemcha Kipgen: Kangpokpi MLA
 - Losii Dikho: Mao MLA

Kuki-Zomi and Meitei Violence

Violence erupted between Kuki-Zomi tribals and the Meitei community, the first clash of its kind in three decades in Manipur. A key trigger was the Meitei demand for Scheduled Tribe (ST) status, which has persisted since 2012. A 2023 High Court direction to consider that request added to tensions with Kuki groups.

- Violence between Kuki-Zomi tribals and Meitei community
- First clash of this kind in three decades in Manipur
- Demand for ST status for Meitei community persisted since 2012
- Meitei Tribe Union petitioned Manipur High Court for tribal status
- Meiteis lost tribal status after the 1949 merger
- High Court judge directed state to consider Meitei ST request in 2023
- Kukis fear ST status would allow Meiteis to buy land in prohibited hill areas
- State evicted 16 Kuki households over forest encroachment, sparking protests
- State withdrew from suspension of operations agreement with KNA and ZRA in March 2023

Mind-map outline

Violence and Immediate Triggers

- Kuki-Zomi vs Meitei clash
 - First in three decades
- Meitei ST status demand
 - Persisted since 2012
 - High Court direction in 2023
- Kuki concerns
 - Land purchase in hill areas
 - 16 households evicted

Historical Background and Divides

Meiteis make up 52 per cent of Manipur's population and live mainly in valley areas covering about 10 per cent of the state. Hill areas cover 89 per cent of the land but have only 20 of the 60 assembly seats, while Meiteis hold 40. Meiteis are restricted from buying land in about 90 per cent of Manipur, whereas tribals can buy land in the Imphal Valley.

- Meiteis comprise 52 per cent of Manipur's population
- Valley areas cover just 10 per cent of the state
- Hill areas cover 89 per cent of the state's land
- Hill areas have 20 MLAs; Meiteis hold 40 of 60 assembly seats
- Meiteis restricted from buying land in 90 per cent of Manipur
- Tribals can buy land in Imphal Valley
- Nagas and Kukis demand greater political autonomy or separate administrative units
- Meitei concerns over inaccurate 2020 census figures and delimitation process
- Concern over rapid growth of villages in Churachandpur due to migrants

Mind-map outline

Manipur's Historical Divides

- Population and land
 - Meiteis: 52% of population
 - Valleys cover 10% of land
- Hill areas
 - Cover 89% of land
 - 20 of 60 seats
- Land rules
 - Meiteis barred in 90% of state
 - Tribals can buy in Imphal Valley

President's Rule: Articles, Duration and Revocation

President's Rule is the Centre's takeover of a state government when the constitutional machinery fails, also called State Emergency. A proclamation must be approved by both Houses of Parliament within 2 months, and then continues for 6 months. It can be extended by Parliament up to a maximum of 3 years and can be revoked by the President at any time.

- Article 355 imposes a duty on the Centre to ensure state governments run per the Constitution
- Article 356 lets the President act when a state government cannot function per the Constitution
- Article 365 covers a state's failure to comply with directions from the Centre
- Both Houses must approve the proclamation within 2 months of its issue
- Approved proclamation continues for 6 months; extension needs Parliament approval every 6 months
- Maximum extension period is 3 years
- Resolutions need a simple majority of members present and voting
- Proclamation can be revoked by a later proclamation without Parliamentary approval
- President can take over state government functions and powers of Governor
- President can declare that Parliament will exercise state legislature powers

Mnemonic - Article Chain: Duty, Takeover, Defiance: 355, 356, 365

355 = Centre's duty to ensure state governments run per the Constitution; 356 = President may act when a state government cannot function per the Constitution; 365 = State fails to comply with directions from the Centre

Mnemonic - Duration Timeline: Two to approve, six to last, three at most

Two = Months within which both Houses must approve the proclamation; Six = Months it continues after approval; Three = Years maximum for extension

Mind-map outline

President's Rule Mechanics

- Articles
 - 355: Centre's duty
 - 356: President's proclamation
 - 365: Non-compliance with Centre
- Duration
 - Approval within 2 months
 - Continues 6 months
 - Extension up to 3 years
- Revocation
 - Any time by proclamation
 - No Parliamentary approval

Key Records and Judicial Review

Manipur has had President's Rule the most number of times, 11, followed by UP, J&K and Punjab. The first three instances were in Punjab, PEPSU and Andhra. In *S.R. Bommai vs Union of India* (1994), the Supreme Court held that the President's power to dismiss a state government is not absolute.

- First three President's Rule: Punjab (1951), PEPSU (1953), Andhra (1954)
- Most instances: Manipur (11), UP (10), J&K (9), Punjab (8)
- Longest total duration: J&K, then Punjab, then Puducherry
- Shortest total duration: Uttarakhand
- Longest single period: J&K
- Shortest single periods: West Bengal, Bihar, Maharashtra
- 38th Amendment Act of 1975 made the President's satisfaction final and not challengeable in any court
- Beyond 1 year, extension needs a National Emergency in operation and Election Commission certification
- *S.R. Bommai vs Union of India* (1994): power to dismiss a state government is not absolute
- Till Parliament approves, President can only suspend the Legislative Assembly

Mnemonic - MUJP Count: MUJP: the four states with the most President's Rule instances

M = Manipur, 11 instances; U = Uttar Pradesh, 10 instances; J = Jammu & Kashmir, 9 instances; P =

Punjab, 8 instances

Mind-map outline

Key Records and Rulings

- Most instances
 - Manipur: 11
 - UP: 10
 - J&K: 9
 - Punjab: 8
- First three instances
 - Punjab 1951
 - PEPSU 1953
 - Andhra 1954
- Judgment
 - S.R. Bommai vs Union of India 1994
 - Power not absolute

Economics

Union Budget 2026-27

Vision and Six Pillars

Nirmala Sitharaman presented the Union Budget 2026-27 as her record ninth consecutive budget, prepared in the newly inaugurated Kartavya Bhawan. It is framed as a Yuva Shakti-driven blueprint anchored in the Viksit Bharat Vision and guided by three Kartavyas. Six pillars of growth organise the agenda across manufacturing, MSMEs, infrastructure, financial stability and city economic regions.

- Presented by Nirmala Sitharaman as her record 9th consecutive Union Budget
- Framed as a Yuva Shakti-driven blueprint anchored in the Viksit Bharat Vision
- Three Kartavyas: Sustain Economic Growth; Fulfill Aspirations; Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas
- First-ever Union Budget tabled on a Sunday, a Parliamentary first
- Pillar 1: Scaling up manufacturing in seven strategic sectors
- Pillar 2: Rejuvenating legacy industrial sectors to boost productivity and competitiveness
- Pillar 3: Creating champion MSMEs to strengthen the backbone of the economy
- Pillar 4: Delivering infrastructure development across the country
- Pillar 5: Ensuring long-term security and stability in economic and financial systems
- Pillar 6: Developing city economic regions to drive regional growth and urban development

Mind-map outline

Vision and Six Pillars

- Vision
 - Viksit Bharat
 - Yuva Shakti blueprint
- Three Kartavyas
 - Sustain economic growth
 - Fulfill aspirations
 - Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas
- Six pillars
 - Manufacturing
 - Legacy industries
 - Champion MSMEs
 - Infrastructure
 - Financial stability
 - City economic regions

Manufacturing, Industry and Infrastructure

The budget pairs manufacturing schemes for biopharma, semiconductors, containers and critical minerals with infrastructure measures for freight, carbon capture and urban growth. SHAKTI aims to make India a global bio-pharmaceutical manufacturing hub, while the Rare Earth Corridor aims to secure the mining-to-manufacturing value chain. Funds for MSMEs, carbon capture and City Economic Regions complete the package.

- Biopharma SHAKTI: outlay of 2,10,000 crore over 5 years to build a global bio-pharma manufacturing hub
- SHAKTI stands for Strategy for Healthcare Advancement through Knowledge, Technology & Innovation
- Bio-economy target: USD 300 Bn by 2030; contributes 4.25% of GDP
- Semiconductor Mission 2.0 shifts focus from assembly to higher-value manufacturing and indigenous IP
- Container scheme aims to reduce dependence on Chinese imports
- Rare Earth Corridor across Odisha, Kerala, Andhra Pradesh and Tamil Nadu
- Dankuni (West Bengal) to Surat (Gujarat) freight corridor proposed for East-West logistics
- SME Growth Fund of 10,000 crore to scale MSMEs into Champion enterprises
- CCUS outlay of 20,000 crore to decarbonise hard-to-abate sectors like steel and cement
- City Economic Regions: 5,000 crore per region over 5 years

Mnemonic - Biopharma SHAKTI expansion: Some Healthcare Advances Kindle Tech Innovation

S = Strategy; H = Healthcare; A = Advancement; K = Knowledge; T = Technology; I = Innovation

Mind-map outline

Manufacturing and Infrastructure

- Biopharma SHAKTI
 - Global bio-pharma manufacturing hub
 - Outlay 2,10,000 crore over 5 years
 - 3 new NIPERs, 7 upgraded
- Electronics and semiconductors
 - Semiconductor Mission 2.0
 - USD 500 Bn ecosystem by 2030-31
 - Reduce import dependence
- Critical minerals and containers
 - Rare Earth Corridor in 4 states
 - Domestic container ecosystem
- MSMEs
 - SME Growth Fund 10,000 crore
 - Champion enterprises
- Infrastructure and energy
 - CCUS 20,000 crore
 - Dankuni-Surat freight corridor proposed
 - 7 high-speed growth connectors
 - Infrastructure Risk Guarantee Fund
 - City Economic Regions 5,000 crore each

Agriculture, Services and Women-led Growth

Agriculture measures centre on Bharat-VISTAAR, an AI-based platform for accessing farm resources, and on higher-margin plantation crops. Creative and service sectors get talent pipelines and the Orange Economy is promoted, while foreign cloud providers using Indian data centres receive a tax holiday. Women-led development gets community-owned retail outlets and STEM hostels for girls.

- Bharat-VISTAAR: Virtually Integrated System to Access Agricultural Resources
- A multi-lingual AI-based platform integrating AgriStack portals and ICAR's agricultural practices
- Special support for sandalwood, agar trees, walnuts and almonds
- Target: Global Brand Status for Indian cashew and cocoa by 2030
- Content Creator Labs in 15,000 Schools and 500 Colleges for the AVGC sector
- Orange Economy coined by Ivan Duque Marquez and Felipe Buitrago in their 2013 work

- Orange Economy value comes mainly from intellectual property, ideas and cultural expression
- Cloud services tax holiday for foreign companies using Indian data centres until 2047
- SHE Marts: community-owned retail outlets for women's SHGs
- One dedicated girls' hostel in each district to retain female students in STEM

Mnemonic - Bharat-VISTAAR expansion: Very Interesting Stories Tell Amazing Agricultural Results
V = Virtually; I = Integrated; S = System; T = to; A A = Access Agricultural; R = Resources

Mind-map outline

Agriculture, Services, Women

- Agriculture
 - Bharat-VISTAAR AI platform
 - Sandalwood, agar, walnut, almond support
 - Cashew and cocoa global brand by 2030
- Creative economy
 - Orange Economy
 - Content Creator Labs: 15,000 schools
- Services and tax
 - Cloud tax holiday till 2047
 - National Institute of Hospitality
- Women-led growth
 - SHE Marts
 - One girls' hostel per district

Taxation and Fiscal Framework

The budget retained existing income tax slabs for FY 2026-27 and replaces the 1961 Act with a new Income Tax Act 2025 from 1 April 2026. Tax changes include a uniform 2% TCS on LRS remittances and a Minimum Alternate Tax cut to 14%. The fiscal framework sets a deficit target of 4.3% of GDP, record capex of 12.2 lakh crore and a total outlay of 53.47 lakh crore.

- New Income Tax Act 2025 replaces the 1961 Act from 1 April 2026 to reduce litigation
- Existing income tax slabs retained for FY 2026-27
- TCS rationalised to a uniform 2% on overseas tours, education and medical remittances under LRS
- MAT proposed as a final tax, rate cut to 14% from 15%; non-residents exempted
- LRS introduced in 2004 by RBI; limit of USD 2,50,000 per financial year
- Projections for FY 2026-27: 10.5% nominal GDP growth and around 7% real GDP growth
- Fiscal deficit target for FY 2026-27 is 4.3% of GDP
- Debt estimated to decline to 55.6% in BE 2026-27 from 56.1% in RE 2025-26
- Record capex of 12.2 lakh crore; total outlay of 53.47 lakh crore
- TCS on LRS is governed under Section 206C of the Income Tax Act 1961

Mind-map outline

Tax and Fiscal Framework

- Income tax
 - New Income Tax Act 2025
 - Replaces 1961 Act
 - Existing slabs retained
- TCS and LRS
 - Uniform 2% TCS
 - LRS limit USD 2,50,000
 - LRS introduced 2004 by RBI
- Minimum Alternate Tax
 - Final tax at 14%
 - Non-residents exempted
- Fiscal indicators
 - Fiscal deficit 4.3% of GDP
 - Debt falls to 55.6% of GDP
 - Total outlay 53.47 lakh crore

Budget Process and Parliament

Article 112 requires the annual financial statement to be laid before Parliament, although the word 'Budget' does not appear in the Constitution. The budget is prepared by the Budget Division of the Department of Economic Affairs with NITI Aayog and ministries. Money Bills start in Lok Sabha, and Rajya Sabha can only return them within 14 days without any power to vote on demands for grants.

- Article 112 (Part V): annual statement of estimated receipts and expenditure of the Government
- The term 'Budget' is not mentioned anywhere in the Constitution
- Budget Division of the Department of Economic Affairs prepares it with NITI Aayog
- Six stages: presentation, general discussion, scrutiny, voting on demands, appropriation bill, finance bill
- Money/Finance Bill involving taxation is introduced only in Lok Sabha
- Rajya Sabha must return a Money/Finance Bill within 14 days
- Railway Budget was presented separately for 92 years, merged with the Union Budget in 2017
- India's first budget was presented on 7 April 1860 by James Wilson
- First post-independence Union Budget presented by R.K. Shanmukham Chetty on 26 Nov 1947
- Budget announcement moved to the 1st working day of February from 2017

Mnemonic - Budget enactment stages: Peter Gave Sam Vegetables And Fruit

P = Presentation of the budget; G = General discussion; S = Scrutiny by departmental committees; V = Voting on demands for grants; A = Passing an Appropriation Bill; F = Passing of Finance Bill

Mind-map outline

Budget Process and Parliament

- Constitution
 - Article 112
 - 'Budget' not in Constitution
 - Budget Division with NITI Aayog
- Six stages
 - Presentation
 - General discussion
 - Scrutiny by committees
 - Voting on demands for grants
 - Appropriation Bill
 - Finance Bill
- Role of Parliament
 - Money Bill starts in Lok Sabha
 - Rajya Sabha returns within 14 days
 - No power on demands for grants
- History
 - First budget 7 April 1860
 - First post-independence budget 1947

16th Finance Commission Report

Constitution and Role of the Commission

The 16th Finance Commission was set up in 2023 under Article 280 to recommend how tax revenue is distributed between the Centre and the States. It has one Chairperson, Dr. Arvind Panagariya, and four other members, appointed by the President for a generally five-year tenure. Its report and an Action Taken Memorandum are laid before Parliament under Article 281, and the Government has accepted its key recommendations for 2026-31.

- Set up in 2023 under Article 280 of the Constitution
- Constitutional body that recommends distribution of tax revenues between Centre and States
- Chairperson: Dr. Arvind Panagariya, former Vice-Chairman of NITI Aayog
- Other members: Ajay Narayan Jha, Annie George Mathew, Niranjan Rajadhyaksha, Soumya Kanti Ghosh
- Composition: 1 Chairperson and 4 other members
- Constituted by the President of India, every five years or earlier if required

- Members appointed for a specified tenure, generally 5 years
- Report and Action Taken Memorandum laid before Parliament under Article 281
- Report tabled in Lok Sabha by the Union Finance Minister
- Central Government is not bound by Finance Commission suggestions

Mind-map outline

Constitution and role of the Commission

- Constitution
 - Set up 2023 under Article 280
 - Constituted by the President
 - Tenure generally 5 years
- Members
 - Chair: Arvind Panagariya
 - Ajay Narayan Jha
 - Annie George Mathew
 - Niranjana Rajadhyaksha
 - Soumya Kanti Ghosh
- Status
 - Report laid under Article 281
 - Centre not bound by suggestions

Vertical and Horizontal Devolution

Vertical devolution fixes the share of the Centre's divisible tax pool transferred to the States, which the 16th Commission kept at 41 per cent. Horizontal devolution decides how that 41 per cent is divided among States, and the revised criteria add GDP contribution while reducing the weight of income distance and geographical area. The divisible pool excludes cesses, surcharges and the cost of collection.

- Vertical devolution: States' share in the divisible pool retained at 41%
- The 41% share is unchanged from the 15th Finance Commission
- Divisible pool includes the Centre's gross tax revenues
- Divisible pool excludes cesses, surcharges and cost of collection
- Horizontal devolution decides how the 41% share is apportioned among States
- Income distance weight cut from 45% to 42.5%
- Population (2011) weight raised from 15% to 17.5%
- Demographic performance weight cut from 12.5% to 10%
- Geographical area weight cut from 15% to 10%
- Contribution to GDP is a new criterion with 10% weight

Mnemonic - Horizontal criteria: Please Don't Attack Fine Ideas Gently

Please = Population (2011): 17.5% in the 16th FC; Don't = Demographic performance: 10%; Attack = Geographical area: 10%; Fine = Forest and ecology: 10%; Ideas = Income distance: 42.5%; Gently = Contribution to GDP: 10% (new criterion)

Mind-map outline

Vertical and horizontal devolution

- Vertical devolution
 - States' share: 41%
 - Pool: gross tax revenue of Centre
 - Excludes cesses and surcharges
- Horizontal devolution
 - Income distance: 42.5%
 - Population (2011): 17.5%
 - Demographic performance: 10%
 - Geographical area: 10%
 - Forest and ecology: 10%
 - Contribution to GDP: 10%

Grants-in-Aid, Cess and Surcharge

Statutory grants under Article 275 go only to States in need of financial assistance and are charged on the Consolidated Fund of India every year. Discretionary grants under Article 282 can be made for any public purpose, and the Centre has no obligation to give them. Cesses and surcharges are levied by the Centre and are not shared with States, while SASCI provides long-term interest-free loans for capital projects.

- Statutory grants under Article 275: Parliament makes grants to States in need of financial assistance
- Statutory grants are not given to every State
- Statutory grants are charged on the Consolidated Fund of India every year
- Discretionary grants under Article 282 can be made for any public purpose
- Discretionary grants can be made even outside legislative competence
- Centre has no obligation to give discretionary grants
- Cess: a 'tax on tax' levied for specific purposes such as education and health
- Cess is mandatory for all taxpayers and is not shared with States
- Surcharge: additional tax on high-income earners, not shared with States
- SASCI launched in 2020-21 gives 50-year interest-free loans to States for capital projects

Mnemonic - Cess versus surcharge: Cess Stays Special, Surcharge Skims the Rich

Cess = Tax on tax levied by the Centre for specific purposes; Special = Cess must be used for a specified purpose; Surcharge = Additional tax on top of base tax; Rich = Surcharge applies to high-income earners or entities

Mnemonic - Statutory versus discretionary grants: Sure Statutory, Dicey Discretionary

Sure = Statutory grants under Article 275 are charged on the Consolidated Fund every year; Dicey = Discretionary grants under Article 282 are not obligatory, since the Centre has no obligation to give them

Mind-map outline

Grants-in-aid, cess and surcharge

- Statutory grants (Art 275)
 - Only to States in need
 - Charged on Consolidated Fund
- Discretionary grants (Art 282)
 - Any public purpose
 - Centre has no obligation
- Cess and surcharge
 - Cess: for specific purposes
 - Surcharge: on high earners
 - Neither shared with States
- SASCI
 - 50-year interest-free loans
 - For capital projects

Fiscal Discipline and Local Bodies

The Commission recommends that the Centre's fiscal deficit fall to 3.5 per cent of GDP and the States' limit be set at 3 per cent of GSDP by 2030-31. It also recommends ending off-budget borrowings by States and performance-linked grants for local bodies. For urban areas it proposes an urbanisation premium and a constitutional change regarding State Finance Commission recommendations.

- Centre's fiscal deficit to be reduced to 3.5% of GDP by 2030-31
- States' fiscal deficit limit set at 3% of GSDP by 2030-31
- Exclusion clause: SASCI borrowings excluded from the deficit limit
- Recommends ending off-budget borrowings by States to enhance fiscal transparency
- Grants to rural and urban local bodies
- Performance-linked grants to rural and urban local bodies improve accountability
- Urbanisation premium of 10,000 crore to merge peri-urban villages into ULBs above 1 lakh population
- Special infrastructure grants of 56,100 crore for wastewater in medium-sized cities (10-50 lakh population)

- Suggested removal of the requirement that Central FC recommendations be made 'on basis of' State FC recommendations
- Urged DISCOM reforms including privatisation, and targeted subsidies with sunset clauses

Mind-map outline

Fiscal discipline and local bodies

- Deficit caps by 2030-31
 - Centre: 3.5% of GDP
 - States: 3% of GSDP
- Borrowing
 - End off-budget borrowings by States
 - SASCI excluded from limit
- Local bodies
 - Grants split 60:40 rural:urban
 - Performance-linked grants
 - Urbanisation premium 10,000 crore
 - Wastewater grant 56,100 crore
- Constitutional reform
 - Drop 'on basis of' State FC requirement

Impact, Concerns and Past Commissions

The retained 41 per cent share is said to give States revenue predictability, and the revised formula is said to safeguard fiscally weaker States. Critics point to the 41 per cent share falling short of the 50 per cent demanded, the reduced weight for demographic performance, and the discontinuation of revenue-deficit grants. Finance Commissions have been appointed since 1951, and the early chairpersons include K.C. Neogy.

- Retaining 41% vertical devolution gives States revenue predictability
- Revised horizontal formula is said to safeguard fiscally weaker States
- Concern: States' share stays at 41% despite demands for 50%
- Concern: lower weight to income distance and new GDP criterion may favour richer, populous States
- Concern: reduced demographic weight raises 'Ageing Before Prosperity' fears, especially in Southern States
- Concern: discontinuing revenue-deficit grants could hurt Hill and Special-category States
- Concern: cesses and surcharges outside the divisible pool reduce untied fiscal space for States
- First Finance Commission (1951) chaired by K.C. Neogy
- Eighth Finance Commission (1982) chaired by Y.B. Chavan
- Fifteenth Finance Commission (2017) chaired by N.K. Singh

Mind-map outline

Impact, concerns and past commissions

- Impact
 - Revenue predictability for States
 - Safeguards fiscally weaker States
- Concerns
 - 41% share vs 50% demand
 - Population penalty
 - Revenue-deficit grants discontinued
 - Equity shift to richer States
- Past commissions
 - First (1951): K.C. Neogy
 - Eighth (1982): Y.B. Chavan
 - Fifteenth (2017): N.K. Singh

CPI Base Year Revised to 2024

Why the CPI base year was revised

The Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation revised the CPI base year to 2024, replacing the 2012 benchmark. The revision reflects updated consumption patterns, price structures and economic changes since 2012. It uses 2023-24 Household Consumer Expenditure Survey data, and an advisory committee chaired by Biswanath Goldar helped decide the base year.

- CPI base year revised to 2024, replacing the 2012 benchmark.
- Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation revised the CPI base year.
- 26-member Advisory Committee on National Accounts Statistics, chaired by Biswanath Goldar.
- 2024 identified as CPI base year using 2023-24 Household Consumer Expenditure Survey data.
- New GDP series released with FY 2022-23 as revised base year.
- Revision aims to reflect updated consumption patterns, price structures and economic changes.
- Since 2012, India's economy shifted towards urbanisation, services expansion and digitalisation of consumer spending.
- Rising incomes and lifestyle changes diversify household expenditure patterns.
- Without periodic revision, an inflation index risks misrepresenting the actual price rise felt by households.

Mind-map outline

Why CPI base revised to 2024

- Replaces 2012 benchmark
 - Reflects updated consumption patterns
 - Reflects changed price structures
- Structural shifts since 2012
 - Urbanisation
 - Services expansion
 - Digitalisation of spending
- Need for policy accuracy
 - Avoids misrepresenting price rise
 - Keeps index credible
- Data base
 - 2023-24 household expenditure survey
 - New GDP series with FY 2022-23 base

What CPI measures and why it matters

The Consumer Price Index measures the average change over time in retail prices of goods and services consumed by households. It is the main indicator of retail inflation and is used by the Reserve Bank of India for monetary policy decisions. It also serves as a benchmark for wage revision, pension adjustment and dearness allowance calculation.

- CPI measures average change over time in retail prices of goods and services consumed by households.
- CPI reflects the cost of living and inflation experienced by consumers.
- CPI is the main indicator of retail inflation.
- CPI is used by the Reserve Bank of India for monetary policy decisions.
- CPI is used for dearness allowance calculation, wage revision and pension adjustment.
- Current inflation target is 4%, with a band of 2% (2% to 6%).
- Overall inflation in January 2026 (YoY) was 2.75% (provisional).
- Rural inflation in January 2026 was 2.73%; urban inflation was 2.77%.
- Significance of base revision: better reflection of cost of living, improved monetary policy transmission, greater statistical credibility.

Mind-map outline

CPI: retail inflation measure

- Measures
 - Average change in retail prices
 - Goods and services consumed by households
- Uses
 - RBI monetary policy decisions
 - Dearness allowance calculation

- Wage revision and pension adjustment
- Significance
 - Better reflection of cost of living
 - Improved monetary policy transmission
 - Greater statistical credibility
- Inflation figures
 - Overall 2.75% (provisional), Jan 2026
 - Target 4%, band 2% to 6%

CPI 2012 versus CPI 2024: key changes

The revised CPI 2024 has a larger basket than CPI 2012, with 358 items against 299. It covers online markets, uses the COICOP 2018 classification, and compiles house rent for both urban and rural areas. The food and beverages weightage has been reduced from 45.86% to 36.75%.

- Items: 299 (259 goods and 40 services) in CPI 2012; 358 (308 goods and 50 services) in CPI 2024.
- Online markets: not covered in CPI 2012; 12 online markets covered in CPI 2024 in cities above 25 lakh population.
- Classification: COICOP 1999 in CPI 2012; COICOP 2018 in CPI 2024.
- House rent index: only urban areas in CPI 2012; urban and rural in CPI 2024, both excluding employer-provided accommodation.
- Data dissemination: combined index only in CPI 2012; rural, urban and combined indices in CPI 2024.
- Food and beverages weightage: 45.86% in CPI 2012; 36.75% in CPI 2024.
- Formula used: Laspeyres index (base year prices, base year weights, current prices).
- Newly added items (January 2026): OTT subscriptions, rural house rent, value-added dairy products, pen drives, babysitting services, fitness equipment, barley products, cleaner fuels.
- Removed items: VCR/VCD/DVD players, tape recorders, radios, cassettes, second hand clothing, rope.

Mnemonic - What changed in CPI 2024: In Our House, Cats Sleep

I = Items rose from 299 to 358; O = Online markets covered (12 markets); H = House rent covers urban and rural areas; C = Classification moved to COICOP 2018; S = State-level rural, urban and combined indices

Mind-map outline

CPI 2012 to CPI 2024 changes

- Basket
 - Items 299 to 358
 - Goods 259 to 308
 - Services 40 to 50
- Coverage
 - 12 online markets added
 - House rent: urban plus rural
 - Rural, urban and combined indices
- Method
 - Classification: COICOP 1999 to 2018
 - Formula: Laspeyres index
- Weights
 - Food and beverages 45.86% to 36.75%

CPI compared with WPI

The Wholesale Price Index (WPI) has a base year of 2011-12 and is released by the Office of Economic Adviser, Ministry of Commerce and Industry. The CPI is released by the National Statistical Office (NSO). WPI covers only goods and excludes indirect taxes, whereas CPI covers both goods and services and includes indirect taxes.

- WPI base year is 2011-12.
- WPI is released by the Office of Economic Adviser, Ministry of Commerce and Industry.
- CPI is released by the National Statistical Office (NSO).
- WPI includes only goods; CPI includes both goods and services.
- WPI excludes indirect taxes; CPI includes indirect taxes.
- WPI does not reflect up-to-date expenditure patterns; CPI does.

Mnemonic - Goods coverage of WPI and CPI: Wholesale: Goods only; Consumer: Goods plus Services
W = WPI includes only goods; C = CPI includes both goods and services

Mind-map outline

CPI and WPI compared

- WPI
 - Base year 2011-12
 - Released by Office of Economic Adviser
 - Goods only, excludes indirect taxes
- CPI
 - Released by NSO
 - Goods and services
 - Includes indirect taxes
 - Reflects up-to-date expenditure

Reports, Summits, Indices

India AI Impact Summit 2026

Summit Theme, Principles and Objectives

India hosted the India AI Impact Summit 2026 at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi, presented as the first multilateral AI summit in the Global South. The summit marked a shift from a Western safety-first model to an impact-first, developmental approach to AI, under the theme 'Sarvajana Hitaya, Sarvajana Sukhaya'. Its work rests on three Sutras and seven Chakras, and it set out four key objectives.

- Held at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi; described as the 1st multilateral AI summit in the Global South
- Signals a shift from a Western safety-first model to an impact-first, developmental AI paradigm
- Theme: 'Sarvajana Hitaya, Sarvajana Sukhaya' (Welfare for All, Happiness for All)
- 3 Sutras: People (Inclusive Development), Planet (Ethical Innovation), Progress (Sustainable Societal Impact)
- 7 Chakras (Priority Cooperation Areas): Healthcare, Agriculture, Education, Governance, Climate action, Digital Economy, Social Inclusion
- Objective 1: translate global AI discussions into development outcomes aligned with IndiaAI Mission and Digital India
- Objective 2: promote responsible and ethical AI, addressing algorithmic bias, privacy protection and accountability
- Objective 3: build partnerships between governments, startups, academia and industry
- Objective 4: position India as a Global AI Hub and promote an indigenous AI ecosystem
- Switzerland will host the 2027 World Summit on AI in Geneva

Mind-map outline

India AI Impact Summit 2026

- Theme: Sarvajana Hitaya, Sarvajana Sukhaya
- 3 Sutras
 - People: Inclusive Development
 - Planet: Ethical Innovation
 - Progress: Sustainable Societal Impact
- 7 Chakras (priority cooperation areas)
 - Healthcare, Agriculture, Education, Governance
 - Climate action, Digital Economy, Social Inclusion
- 4 key objectives
 - Translate discussions into development outcomes
 - Responsible and ethical AI
 - Global cooperation
 - Global AI Hub for India

New Delhi Declaration and Its Seven Pillars

The New Delhi Declaration on AI was adopted at the summit and focuses on inclusive, ethical and development-oriented AI. It is endorsed by 87 countries and 2 international organisations and is built around seven pillars supported by voluntary global initiatives. Separately, the New Delhi Frontier AI Impact Commitments form a voluntary framework signed by frontier AI companies and domestic innovators.

- Adopted at the India AI Impact Summit 2026; focuses on inclusive, ethical and development-oriented AI
- Endorsed by 87 countries and 2 international organisations (European Union and International Fund for Agricultural Development)
- Built around 7 pillars, each supported by voluntary global initiatives
- Charter for Democratic Diffusion of AI: promotes locally relevant AI ecosystems and Global South participation
- Global AI Impact Commons: platform for sharing successful AI solutions and replicating best practices globally
- Trusted AI Commons: repository of tools, benchmarks, safety standards and best practices
- International Network of AI for Science Institutions: connects research institutions for collaborative scientific innovation
- AI for Social Empowerment Platform: platform for sharing scalable AI solutions for social welfare
- AI Workforce Development Playbook & Reskilling Principles: guidance for governments to prepare workforce for AI transformation
- Guiding Principles on Resilient & Efficient AI: focus on sustainability and energy-efficient AI systems

Mind-map outline

New Delhi Declaration on AI

- Endorsed by 87 countries and 2 organisations
- 7 pillars with voluntary initiatives
 - Charter for Democratic Diffusion of AI
 - Global AI Impact Commons
 - Trusted AI Commons
 - International Network of AI for Science Institutions
 - AI for Social Empowerment Platform
 - AI Workforce Development Playbook
 - Resilient and Efficient AI principles
- Frontier AI Impact Commitments
 - Voluntary framework
 - Real-world AI usage understanding
 - Multilingual and contextual evaluations

M.A.N.A.V. Roadmap and Previous AI Summits

The Prime Minister unveiled the human-centric M.A.N.A.V. Framework for Ethical and Inclusive AI at the summit, with each letter standing for one principle. The booklet also traces earlier global AI summits: the UK's 1st AI Safety Summit and its Bletchley Declaration, the Seoul Summit of 2024 and the 3rd AI Action Summit held in Paris in 2025.

- Prime Minister unveiled the human-centric M.A.N.A.V. Framework for Ethical and Inclusive AI at the summit
- M: Moral and Ethical Systems; AI must be fair and transparent, subject to human oversight
- A: Accountable Governance; clear institutional responsibility, transparent regulatory rules, strong oversight
- N: National Sovereignty; securing critical datasets, strengthening domestic compute, indigenous model development
- A: Accessible and Inclusive AI; democratise benefits, bridge the digital divide, reach marginalised populations
- V: Valid and Legitimate Systems; trust, safety and legal compliance, important given deepfakes and misinformation
- UK hosted the 1st AI Safety Summit and adopted the Bletchley Declaration on AI's promises and risks

- Bletchley Declaration emphasises aligning AI with human intent, safeguarding rights, safety, ethics and accountability
- AI Seoul Summit took place in 2024, co-hosted by the Republic of Korea and the UK government
- 3rd AI Action Summit was held in 2025 in Paris, France

Mnemonic - M.A.N.A.V. principles: Mindful Accountable Nations Act Visibly

M = Moral and Ethical Systems; A = Accountable Governance; N = National Sovereignty; A = Accessible and Inclusive AI; V = Valid and Legitimate Systems

Mnemonic - Summit chronology: Bright Summers Pass

Bright = Bletchley Declaration, adopted at the UK-hosted 1st AI Safety Summit; Summers = AI Seoul Summit, 2024, co-hosted by Republic of Korea and UK; Pass = 3rd AI Action Summit, 2025, in Paris

Mind-map outline

AI governance roadmap

- M.A.N.A.V. Framework
 - M: Moral and Ethical Systems
 - A: Accountable Governance
 - N: National Sovereignty
 - A: Accessible and Inclusive AI
 - V: Valid and Legitimate Systems
- Previous AI Summits
 - UK: 1st AI Safety Summit, Bletchley Declaration
 - Seoul Summit 2024: Korea and UK
 - Paris AI Action Summit 2025

Sovereign Models and Domain Platforms

India's sovereign AI models include Sarvam's large language models, the Vikram chatbot, Gnani.ai's Vachana speech model and BharatGen's Param2 17B. Bharat GenAI develops foundational models tailored to 22 Indian languages, while BODH, SAHI, VoicERA and BHASHINI cover health and language platforms. The Bio-AI Mulankur Hubs link AI with biotechnology under the BioE3 policy.

- Sarvam-30B and Sarvam-105B by Sarvam AI are large language models that generate human-like text
- Sarvam's Vikram is a multilingual chatbot for seamless conversations across Indian languages
- Vachana is a text-to-speech model by Gnani.ai that supports 12 Indian languages
- Param2 17B is a multilingual foundational AI model by BharatGen
- Bharat GenAI: India's first government-supported initiative for sovereign foundational AI models, spearheaded by IIT Bombay
- Bharat GenAI models are tailored to 22 Indian languages and cover text, text-to-speech and vision-language
- BODH: privacy-preserving benchmarking platform for health AI using diverse, real-world health data; positioned under Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission
- SAHI (Strategy for Artificial Intelligence in Healthcare for India): national framework for responsible AI integration in healthcare
- VoicERA: open-source, end-to-end voice AI stack serving as a national execution layer for multilingual voice AI
- BHASHINI (Bhasha Interface for India): AI-powered national language translation and speech platform under Digital India

Mind-map outline

Sovereign models and platforms

- Sovereign language models
 - Sarvam-30B and Sarvam-105B
 - Vikram multilingual chatbot
 - Param2 17B by BharatGen
 - Vachana TTS by Gnani.ai
- Bharat GenAI
 - Spearheaded by IIT Bombay
 - 22 Indian languages
- Health AI platforms
 - BODH: benchmarking health AI

- SAHI: healthcare AI framework
- Language and speech platforms
 - VoicERA: open-source voice AI stack
 - BHASHINI: national translation and speech
- Bio-AI Mulankur Hubs
 - Integrates AI with biotechnology under BioE3
 - Closed-loop AI and lab validation

Flagship Initiatives, Funding and Global Bodies

India's flagship initiatives include the IndiaAI Mission, which builds AI infrastructure around sovereign GPUs, and programmes for startups, women and youth. The summit highlighted large pledges, including \$20 billion for frontier deep-tech research. Global context comes from GPAI, established in 2020, and the G7 Hiroshima AI Process, which sets guardrails for advanced AI systems.

- IndiaAI Mission: builds AI infrastructure with 10,000 GPUs initially, backed by a budget of 10,372 crore
- GPU target: initially 10,000, achieved 38,000, with 20,000 new GPUs being added
- IndiaAI Mission 2.0 aims to onboard 38,000 sovereign GPUs and advance the National Compute Portal and strategic compute autonomy
- AIRAWAT: India's largest AI supercomputing system at C-DAC Pune, manufactured by Netweb Technologies
- AIRAWAT stands for AI Research, Analytics and Knowledge Assimilation
- AI for ALL: identifies scalable AI solutions for development challenges, implemented with Startup India
- AI by HER: promotes women-led AI innovation, implemented with NITI Aayog's Women Entrepreneurship Platform
- YUVAi: encourages AI innovation among youth aged 13-21
- \$20 billion pledged for frontier deep-tech research
- GPAI (Global Partnership on AI): established 2020, officially proposed by France and Canada; secretariat in Paris (OECD); 2024 summit held in India

Mind-map outline

Flagship initiatives and global bodies

- IndiaAI Mission
 - 10,000 GPUs initially
 - 38,000 GPUs achieved
 - Budget of 10,372 crore
- Social and youth programmes
 - AI for ALL, with Startup India
 - AI by HER, women-led innovation
 - YUVAi, ages 13-21
- Compute and funding
 - AIRAWAT at C-DAC Pune
 - \$20 billion for deep-tech research
 - \$250 billion AI infrastructure push
- Global bodies and processes
 - GPAI, established 2020
 - G7 Hiroshima AI Process
 - US \$500 billion Stargate Project

Corruption Perceptions Index 2025

Global CPI 2025 Findings

Transparency International released the Corruption Perceptions Index 2025, which assesses public sector corruption in 182 countries on a scale from 0 (Highly Corrupt) to 100 (Very Clean). The global average fell to 42, the lowest level in over a decade, signalling worsening corruption trends. Denmark remained the least corrupt country, while only five countries scored above 80.

- CPI 2025 assessed public sector corruption across 182 countries.

- CPI scale runs from 0 (Highly Corrupt) to 100 (Very Clean).
- Transparency International, founded in 1993, released CPI 2025; the index started in 1995.
- Global average CPI score declined to 42, the lowest level in over a decade.
- About 122 of 182 countries scored below 50.
- Denmark ranked 1st with a score of 89.
- Denmark has been the least corrupt country for 8 consecutive years.
- Only 5 countries scored above 80, compared with 12 a decade ago.
- Somalia and South Sudan, each scoring 9, ranked among the most corrupt, along with Venezuela.

Mind-map outline

Global CPI 2025 Findings

- Scale and coverage
 - 182 countries assessed
 - 0 Highly Corrupt, 100 Very Clean
- Global trend
 - Global average 42, decade low
 - About 122 of 182 below 50
 - Only 5 countries above 80
- Top performers
 - Denmark 1st with 89
 - Finland, Singapore, New Zealand, Norway
- Most corrupt
 - Somalia and South Sudan, each 9
 - Venezuela also among most corrupt

India's CPI 2025 Performance

India ranked 91st out of 182 countries with a score of 39 out of 100 in CPI 2025. This is a modest improvement from its 96th rank in 2024, but the score remains below the global average of 42. The source attributes this to persistent governance and accountability challenges.

- India ranked 91st out of 182 countries in CPI 2025.
- India scored 39 out of 100 in CPI 2025.
- India's rank was a modest improvement from 96th in 2024.
- India's score remains below the global average of 42.
- The booklet links India's position to persistent governance and accountability challenges.
- India performs better than Pakistan, Bangladesh, Nepal and Sri Lanka.
- India lags behind countries such as Bhutan and China.

Mind-map outline

India's CPI 2025 Performance

- Rank
 - 91st of 182 countries
 - Up from 96th in 2024
- Score
 - 39 out of 100
 - Below global average of 42
- Regional position
 - Ahead of Pakistan, Bangladesh, Nepal, Sri Lanka
 - Behind Bhutan and China
- Reason given
 - Persistent governance and accountability challenges

India's Laws and Agencies

India's anti-corruption framework combines statutes such as the Prevention of Corruption Act 1988 and the Right to Information Act 2005 with bodies including the CVC, CBI, ED and CAG. The CVC oversees vigilance administration, while the CBI is the premier investigating police agency for combating corruption in public life. The CAG is the Supreme Audit Institution that helps identify financial mismanagement, corruption or fraud.

- Prevention of Corruption Act 1988 provides penalties for corruption by public servants and for abetment of corruption.

- Prevention of Money Laundering Act 2002 prohibits use of proceeds of crime in India.
- Right to Information Act 2005 gives citizens smoother and greater access to information.
- Whistleblower Protection Act 2014 allows registration of corruption or misuse of power against public servants.
- Central Vigilance Commission was established in 1964 on K Santhanam Committee recommendations.
- CVC was granted statutory status by the CVC Act 2003 and is headquartered in New Delhi.
- Central Bureau of Investigation was formed in 1963 and is the premier investigating police agency for corruption in public life.
- Directorate of Enforcement was established in 1956 as an Enforcement Unit under the Ministry of Finance.
- The CAG is the Supreme Audit Institution under Art 148, appointed by the President.
- The CAG holds office for 6 years or up to the age of 65 years.

Mnemonic - Four Indian laws: Please Make Right Wrongs

P = Prevention of Corruption Act 1988; M = Prevention of Money Laundering Act 2002; R = Right to Information Act 2005; W = Whistleblower Protection Act 2014

Mind-map outline

India's Laws and Agencies

- Laws
 - Prevention of Corruption Act 1988
 - Prevention of Money Laundering Act 2002
 - Right to Information Act 2005
 - Whistleblower Protection Act 2014
- Agencies
 - CVC: established 1964, statutory status 2003
 - CBI: formed 1963, premier investigator
 - ED: 1956 as Enforcement Unit
 - CAG: Supreme Audit Institution, Art 148

International Efforts and Bodies

UNCAC 2003 is the only legally binding universal anti-corruption instrument, and India ratified it in 2011. The FATF, set up by the G7 in 1989, acts as a watchdog on money laundering and terrorist financing. INTERPOL, established in 1923, is the world's largest international police organisation, and SDG 16 recognises anti-corruption as an institutional principle.

- UN Convention against Corruption 2003 is the only legally binding universal anti-corruption instrument.
- India ratified UNCAC in 2011.
- G20 Anti-Corruption Working Group (2010) shares effective strategies to combat corruption, especially through emerging technologies.
- Financial Action Task Force was established in 1989 by the G7.
- FATF has 38 member countries and 2 member organisations: the Gulf Cooperation Council and the European Union.
- FATF Black List labels Iran, North Korea and Myanmar as Non-Cooperative Countries or Territories.
- FATF Grey List has 21 countries.
- SDG 16 acknowledges anti-corruption as an institutional principle.
- INTERPOL was established in 1923 and has 196 member countries, including India.
- INTERPOL's General Assembly is its highest decision-making body, with one delegate from each member nation.

Mnemonic - FATF lists: Black Blocks, Grey Gets Watched

Black = Labelled Non-Cooperative Countries or Territories; Grey = Grey List has 21 countries

Mind-map outline

International Efforts and Bodies

- UN and G20
 - UNCAC 2003, only binding universal instrument
 - India ratified UNCAC in 2011
 - G20 Anti-Corruption Working Group, 2010
- FATF

- Set up 1989 by G7
- 38 countries and 2 organisations
- Black List: Iran, North Korea, Myanmar
- Grey List: 21 countries
- INTERPOL
 - Founded 1923, 196 members
 - General Assembly: highest decision body
- SDG 16
 - Anti-corruption as institutional principle

Environment & Biodiversity

NGT Clears Great Nicobar Mega Infrastructure Project

Project Overview and Clearance

The Great Nicobar Mega Infrastructure Project was launched in 2021, credited to NITI Aayog, and is located on Great Nicobar Island, the southernmost island of India. The National Green Tribunal upheld its Environmental Clearance, citing compliance with Island Coastal Regulation Zone and Coastal Regulation Zone norms. The Andaman and Nicobar Islands Integrated Development Corporation is the implementing agency.

- Launched in 2021, credited to NITI Aayog.
- Located on Great Nicobar Island, the southernmost and largest Nicobar island.
- Indira Point is the southernmost point of India.
- Components: International Container Transshipment Terminal, 450 MVA gas and solar-based power plant, dual-use civil-military airport, integrated township.
- Strategic importance: near the Malacca Strait, vital to India's Act East Policy and QUAD Indo-Pacific Strategy.
- Economic aim: cut reliance on Singapore and Colombo ports.
- Implementing agency: Andaman and Nicobar Islands Integrated Development Corporation.
- Covered areas include Galathea Bay, Campbell Bay and Great Nicobar, with a Biosphere Reserve and two national parks.

Mnemonic - Project components: Cats And Ponies Trot

C = International Container Transshipment Terminal; A = Dual-use civil-military Airport; P = 450 MVA gas and solar-based Power plant; T = Integrated Township

Mind-map outline

Great Nicobar Mega Infrastructure Project

- Launch and location
 - Launched 2021 (NITI Aayog)
 - Great Nicobar Island
 - Indira Point: southernmost point
- Components
 - Container transshipment terminal
 - 450 MVA gas and solar power
 - Dual-use civil-military airport
 - Integrated township
- Strategic aim
 - Near Malacca Strait
 - Act East and QUAD links
 - Cut reliance on Singapore and Colombo ports

Environmental and Tribal Concerns

The project is criticised for diverting about 130 sq. km of tropical rainforest and cutting nearly 1 million trees. The Environmental Impact Assessment used single-season data, and the proposed afforestation in Haryana cannot replicate the island's rainforest ecosystem. Tribal groups, including the Shompen and Nicobarese, face loss of habitat, cultural disruption and livelihood impact.

- About 130 sq. km of tropical rainforest is to be diverted.

- Nearly 1 million trees are to be cut.
- The Environmental Impact Assessment was based on single-season data.
- Concerns exist over inadequate ecological evaluation.
- Proposed afforestation in Haryana cannot replicate the tropical rainforest ecosystem.
- Shompen (a Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Group) and the Nicobarese tribe are affected.
- Concerns include loss of habitat, cultural disruption and livelihood impact.
- The island lies in the highest seismic risk zone, vulnerable to earthquakes, tsunamis and climate change impacts.

Mnemonic - Tribal impact concerns: Hold Culture, Livelihood

H = Loss of Habitat; C = Cultural Disruption; L = Livelihood Impact

Mind-map outline

Environmental and tribal concerns

- Biodiversity loss
 - 130 sq. km rainforest diverted
 - Nearly 1 million trees cut
- Assessment gaps
 - EIA used single-season data
 - Ecological evaluation seen as inadequate
- Afforestation gap
 - Haryana cannot replicate rainforest
- Tribal impact
 - Shompen and Nicobarese affected
 - Habitat, culture, livelihood at risk
- Hazards
 - Highest seismic risk zone
 - Earthquakes, tsunamis, climate change

Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups

A Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Group (PVTG), previously called a Primitive Tribal Group, is a sub-classification of Scheduled Tribes that is more vulnerable than a regular Scheduled Tribe. The Dhebar Commission set up the PTG category in 1973, and the Government renamed these groups PVTGs in 2006. PM-JANMAN, with an outlay of Rs. 24,000 crore, aims to improve their socio-economic conditions.

- A PVTG is a sub-classification of Scheduled Tribe that is more vulnerable than a regular Scheduled Tribe.
- PVTGs were previously known as Primitive Tribal Groups (PTGs).
- The Dhebar Commission established the PTG category in 1973.
- The Government of India renamed PTGs as PVTGs in 2006.
- Salient features: technological backwardness, stagnant or declining population growth, low literacy, subsistence economy, challenging living conditions.
- The Ministry of Tribal Affairs has identified 75 PVTGs across 18 states and one Union Territory.
- PM-JANMAN has an outlay of Rs. 24,000 crore.
- PM-JANMAN covers safe housing, clean drinking water, sanitation, health and nutrition, and road and telecom connectivity.

Mind-map outline

Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups

- Definition
 - Sub-class of Scheduled Tribe
 - More vulnerable than regular ST
 - Earlier called Primitive Tribal Groups
- History
 - Dhebar Commission, 1973
 - Renamed PVTG in 2006
- Features
 - Technological backwardness
 - Stagnant or declining population
 - Low literacy

- Subsistence economy
- Count and support
 - 75 PVTGs in 18 states and 1 UT
 - PM-JANMAN: Rs. 24,000 crore outlay

National Green Tribunal

The National Green Tribunal is a specialised environmental tribunal set up under the National Green Tribunal Act (2010), and India is the third country after Australia and New Zealand to do so. It provides relief and compensation for environmental damage, applying the polluter pays principle and sustainable development. Its decisions can be appealed in the Supreme Court within 90 days.

- Set up under the National Green Tribunal Act (2010).
- India is the third country, after Australia and New Zealand, to set up a specialised environmental tribunal.
- Principal seat is in New Delhi; regional benches include Bhopal, Pune and Chennai.
- Chairperson: a retired Supreme Court judge or High Court Chief Justice, appointed in consultation with the Chief Justice of India.
- Judicial members: 10-20, exact number decided by the Central Government.
- Hears civil cases under seven laws; excludes the Wildlife Protection Act 1972 and the Forest Rights Act 2006.
- Appeals can be filed in the Supreme Court within 90 days.
- Appeals must be disposed of within 6 months of filing.

Mnemonic - Appeal and disposal timelines: Ninety to appeal, six months to decide
 90 = Days within which an appeal can be filed in the Supreme Court; 6 = Months within which NGT appeals must be disposed of

Mind-map outline

National Green Tribunal

- Basis
 - NGT Act (2010)
 - Third country after Australia and NZ
- Composition
 - Chairperson: retired SC judge or HC CJ
 - Judicial members: 10-20
- Powers
 - Civil cases under seven laws
 - Excludes Wildlife Protection Act 1972
 - Excludes Forest Rights Act 2006
- Appeals and timelines
 - Appeal to Supreme Court in 90 days
 - Dispose of appeals in 6 months
- Principles
 - Natural justice
 - Polluter pays
 - Sustainable development

World Wetlands Day 2026

Why in News: World Wetlands Day 2026

World Wetlands Day is observed on 2 February, and the 2026 theme is 'Wetlands and Traditional Knowledge: Celebrating Cultural Heritage'. India's Ramsar Network was expanded when the Union Environment Minister added two new wetlands, bringing the total to 98. Patna Bird Sanctuary in Etah District, Uttar Pradesh, was recognised as the state's smallest bird sanctuary.

- World Wetlands Day is observed on 2 February.
- The 2026 theme is Wetlands and Traditional Knowledge: Celebrating Cultural Heritage.
- Union Environment Minister added two new wetlands to India's Ramsar Network.
- India's Ramsar Network total reaches 98.
- Patna Bird Sanctuary is in Etah District, Uttar Pradesh.

- Patna Bird Sanctuary was established in 1991.
- Patna Bird Sanctuary is recognised as the state's smallest bird sanctuary.
- Chhari-Dhand Wetland Reserve is in Gujarat's Rann of Kutch.
- Chhari-Dhand is famous for Chir Batti night lights across Banni Grasslands.

Mind-map outline

2026 Wetlands Day News

- Theme
 - Wetlands and Traditional Knowledge: Celebrating Cultural Heritage
- Ramsar Network
 - Two new wetlands added
 - Total reaches 98
- Patna Bird Sanctuary
 - Etah District, Uttar Pradesh
 - Established 1991
 - State's smallest bird sanctuary
- Chhari-Dhand Reserve
 - Gujarat, Rann of Kutch
 - Chir Batti night lights
 - Banni Grasslands

Meaning and Classification of Wetlands

A wetland is a place where land is covered by water, which may be salt, fresh or in between, and may be seasonal or permanent. The term covers a wide range of water bodies and coastal habitats, from lakes and rivers to mangroves and coral reefs. For classification, wetlands are grouped into three segments.

- Wetland: land covered by water that is salt, fresh or in between.
- The water cover may be seasonal or permanent.
- Includes lakes, rivers and underground aquifers.
- Includes swamps, wet grasslands and peatlands.
- Includes deltas, tidal flats and mangroves.
- Includes coral reefs and other coastal areas.
- Wetlands are classified into three segments.
- The three segments are Inland, Coastal and Human-made wetlands.

Mnemonic - Three wetland segments: I Can Help

I = Inland wetlands; C = Coastal wetlands; H = Human-made wetlands

Mind-map outline

Wetland Meaning and Segments

- Definition
 - Land covered by water
 - Salt, fresh or in between
 - Seasonal or permanent
- Water bodies
 - Lakes, rivers, aquifers
 - Swamps, wet grasslands, peatlands
 - Deltas, tidal flats, mangroves
- Coastal areas
 - Mangroves
 - Coral reefs
- Three segments
 - Inland
 - Coastal
 - Human-made

Ramsar Convention and Montreux Record

The Ramsar Convention, formally the Convention on Wetlands of International Importance, was signed in 1971 in Ramsar, Iran, and came into force in 1975. It is the only international treaty addressing a specific ecosystem, and its Conference of Parties meets every 3 years. The Montreux Record, launched in 1990, lists wetland sites where ecological character has changed or is likely to change due to technological developments, pollution or other human interference.

- The Ramsar Convention was signed in 1971 in Ramsar, Iran.
- The Convention came into force in 1975.
- It is the only international treaty addressing a specific ecosystem.
- The Convention has 172 member States.
- India became a signatory on 1 February 1982.
- The Conference of Parties (COP) meets every 3 years.
- COP15 took place in 2025 in Victoria Falls, Zimbabwe.
- Bolivia has the largest area under Convention protection.
- The Montreux Record was launched in 1990 to register sites with changed ecological character.
- Keoladeo National Park and Loktak Lake are on the Montreux Record; Chilka Lake was removed.

Mnemonic - Triggers for Montreux Record: Think Pollution Hurts

T = Technological developments; P = Pollution; H = Other human interference

Mind-map outline

Ramsar and Montreux Record

- Ramsar Convention
 - Signed 1971, Ramsar, Iran
 - In force 1975
 - 172 member States
 - Largest area: Bolivia
- Conference of Parties
 - Meets every 3 years
 - COP15: 2025, Victoria Falls
- Montreux Record
 - Launched 1990
 - Changed ecological character
 - Keoladeo and Loktak listed
 - Chilka Lake removed
- India
 - Signatory from 1 Feb 1982

Government Initiatives and Wetland City Accreditation

Amrit Dharohar is a capacity building scheme between the Ministry of Tourism and the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change, aimed at optimal wetland use and nature tourism. The National Wetland Conservation Program is implemented through State Wetland Authorities, and the National Wetland Decadal Change Atlas was prepared by SAC, ISRO. The Wetland City Accreditation Program promotes conservation and wise use of urban and peri-urban wetlands.

- Amrit Dharohar is a collaboration of the Ministry of Tourism and the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change.
- Amrit Dharohar aims to enhance biodiversity, carbon stock, eco-tourism and local income.
- Its primary focus is a shift from High-Volume Tourism to High-Value Nature Tourism at sensitive wetlands.
- The National Wetland Conservation Program (1986) is implemented through State Wetland Authorities.
- The National Wetland Decadal Change Atlas was prepared by the Space Applications Centre (SAC, ISRO).
- The original Atlas was released by SAC in 2011.
- A Nature-Culture Tourism Corridor will be developed between Ayodhya and Devi Patan in UP.
- Wetland City Accreditation is part of the Ramsar Convention.
- Accreditation is granted only to cities meeting all 6 international criteria.

- Accreditation is approved at COP 12 (2015) and is valid for 6 years.

Mind-map outline

Government Schemes and Accreditation

- Amrit Dharohar
 - Tourism + MoEFCC collaboration
 - High-value nature tourism
 - Carbon stock and biodiversity
- National Wetland Conservation
 - Programme started 1986
 - Implemented by State Wetland Authorities
- Decadal Change Atlas
 - Prepared by SAC, ISRO
 - Original released 2011
- Wetland City Accreditation
 - Part of Ramsar Convention
 - Approved COP 12, 2015
 - Valid 6 years
- Ayodhya - Devi Patan corridor
 - Nature-culture tourism, UP

Miscellaneous

Miscellaneous

India-France Partnership

India and France upgraded their ties to a Special Global Strategic Partnership during the French President's visit. Cooperation spans defence manufacturing, technology, critical minerals, nuclear energy and trade. The 2026 India-France Year of Innovation and the Horizon 2047 roadmap set the course for future ties.

- Ties upgraded to Special Global Strategic Partnership during French President's visit
- H125 helicopter final assembly line inaugurated at Vemagal, Karnataka (TATA-Airbus)
- Joint venture of Bharat Electronics and Safran to produce HAMMER missile in India
- 2026 is the India-France Year of Innovation; India-France Innovation Network established
- Joint declaration to secure diversified, resilient supply chains of critical minerals
- Bilateral trade FY 2024-25: EUR 12.67 billion; France is 11th largest foreign investor in India
- France is India's most frequent Republic Day Chief Guest (6th time)
- India and France jointly constructing Jaitapur nuclear park in Maharashtra with EDF
- Namaste France 2028 to celebrate 30 years of Strategic Partnership

Mind-map outline

India-France Relations

- Strategic ties
 - Special Global Strategic Partnership
 - Horizon 2047 roadmap
 - Namaste France 2028
- Defence and aerospace
 - Rafale and Mirage 2000 imports
 - HAMMER missile joint venture with Safran
 - H125 helicopter line in Karnataka
- Technology and innovation
 - India-France Year of Innovation 2026
 - Indo-French AI in Health centre
 - Strategic Space Dialogue 2026
- Economy and energy
 - Bilateral trade EUR 12.67 billion
 - Jaitapur nuclear park, Maharashtra
 - France 11th largest foreign investor

Chabahar Port and Arab League

Iran reaffirmed its commitment to Chabahar Port despite US sanctions uncertainty, and India Ports Global operates the port's terminals. The port gives India a route to Afghanistan and Central Asia that bypasses Pakistan. India and the Arab League also adopted the Delhi Declaration.

- Chabahar is Iran's only ocean-facing deep-water port, on the Makran Coast near the Strait of Hormuz
- Chabahar is about 550 nautical miles from Gujarat's Kandla Port
- Discussions on Indian participation began in 2002; formal recognition came in the 2003 New Delhi Declaration
- India Ports Global assumed operational control of Chabahar Port in 2018
- In 2024, India signed a 10-year contract to operate Shahid Beheshti and Shahid Kalantari terminals
- Chabahar is an integral part of the International North-South Transport Corridor
- Arab League was established in 1945 in Cairo; it has 22 members including Palestine
- Arab States supply over 47% of India's crude oil imports
- Over 9 million Indians reside and work in Arab League countries

Mind-map outline

Chabahar Port and Arab League

- Chabahar Port
 - Iran's only ocean-facing deep-water port
 - India Ports Global control since 2018
 - 10-year contract signed in 2024
 - Route bypassing Pakistan
- Arab League
 - Founded 1945 in Cairo
 - 22 members including Palestine
 - Delhi Declaration with India
- India's stakes
 - Over 47% of crude oil imports
 - Over 9 million Indians in region

Malaysia and Seychelles Visits

The Prime Minister's visit to Malaysia produced a joint statement covering defence, digital and trade cooperation. Seychelles' President visited India to announce the SESEL joint vision, marking 50 years of diplomatic relations, along with a USD 175 million assistance package. Both visits stress disaster-resilient infrastructure, and the Seychelles visit also stresses maritime security.

- India and Malaysia set up a Strategic Affairs Working Group and a Su-30 Forum for air forces
- Malaysia-India Digital Council formalised for fintech, AI, cybersecurity and e-governance
- RBI and Bank Negara Malaysia to promote local currency settlement
- Malaysia is India's 3rd largest trading partner in ASEAN
- Harimau Shakti (5th Edition) is a joint military exercise with Malaysia
- Malaysia formally acceded to the International Big Cat Alliance
- SESEL: Joint Vision for Sustainability, Growth and Security through Enhanced Linkages
- India announced a USD 175 million assistance package for Seychelles
- Seychelles to become a full member of the Colombo Security Conclave

Mind-map outline

Malaysia and Seychelles Visits

- Malaysia
 - Strategic Affairs Working Group
 - Malaysia-India Digital Council
 - Local currency settlement via RBI
 - Harimau Shakti exercise
- Seychelles
 - SESEL joint vision
 - USD 175 million package
 - Colombo Security Conclave membership
- Shared priorities
 - Maritime security

- Disaster-resilient infrastructure

Law, Governance and Parliament

The Supreme Court questioned WhatsApp's 2021 privacy policy in an appeal against a CCI penalty, flagging data sharing and consent concerns. The topic also covers the Motion of Thanks, the removal procedure for the Lok Sabha Speaker, the Governor's address and the Sahyog Portal. Other items include MTP Act limits, the Frontier Nagaland Territorial Authority and Bharat Taxi.

- WhatsApp's 2021 privacy policy allows user data sharing with Facebook (Meta) and group companies
- Supreme Court flagged commercial exploitation of data, abuse of dominant position and lack of informed consent
- Motion of Thanks is moved after the President's address; PM replies by convention
- Speaker removal needs a resolution passed by a majority of all then members, with 14 days' notice
- Speaker cannot preside during own removal discussion and cannot use a casting vote
- Delhi High Court: Section 79 safe harbour does not exempt intermediaries from Sahyog Portal compliance
- Frontier Nagaland Territorial Authority gets devolved powers over 46 subjects; Article 371(A) unaffected
- MTP Act: up to 20 weeks needs 1 registered medical practitioner; 20-24 weeks needs 2
- Bharat Taxi is a driver-owned cooperative; 80% of earnings go directly to Sarathis

Mnemonic - MTP Act gestational limits: One, Two, Board

One = Up to 20 weeks: opinion of 1 Registered Medical Practitioner; Two = 20-24 weeks: approval of 2 medical practitioners; Board = Beyond 24 weeks: only specified categories, with State-level Medical Board approval

Mnemonic - Speaker removal rules: Fourteen, Fifty, All

Fourteen = Minimum 14 days' notice before the resolution is moved; Fifty = At least 50 Members must support the notice for admission; All = Removal needs a majority of all the then members of the House

Mind-map outline

Law, Governance and Parliament

- Data privacy
 - WhatsApp 2021 policy: data sharing with Meta
 - Concerns: consent, dominance, purpose limitation
- Parliament and Governor
 - Motion of Thanks after President's address
 - Speaker removal: resolution, 14 days notice
 - Governor's address is an executive act
- Governance and cyber
 - Sahyog Portal and Section 79 IT Act
 - Frontier Nagaland Territorial Authority
 - Bharat Taxi cooperative model
- Social and welfare
 - MTP Act: 20 and 24 week limits
 - Electoral trusts: 82.5% to ruling party

Economy, Science, Defence and Space

The 10-year government bond yield rose to 6.77%, the highest closing level since mid-January 2025. Science and innovation efforts include the BIRAC-run RDI Fund and the BioE3 policy, while defence approvals and India's command of CTF-154 mark a wider maritime role. Two telescope projects in Ladakh will add to India's observatory network.

- 10-year government bond yield raised to 6.77%; bond yields and prices move in opposite directions
- One State One RRB policy (from 2005) merges multiple regional rural banks within a state
- Digital rupee: e-W for wholesale interbank use, e-R for retail; CBDC food coupon pilot under PDS
- BIRAC RDI Fund is a 6-year scheme supporting technologies at TRL 4 and above
- Defence Acquisition Council approved proposals including Rafale (4.5 generation) and P-81 aircraft
- India assumed command of Combined Task Force 154, the maritime training task force, for the first time

- Combined Maritime Forces has 47 nations including India; headquarters at Manama (Bahrain)
- National Large Solar Telescope: 2-metre aperture, located at Merak (Ladakh)
- National Large Optical Telescope: 13.7-metre segmented mirror telescope at Hanle (Ladakh)
- US launched the FORGE initiative on critical minerals at the Critical Minerals Ministerial

Mnemonic - FORGE initiative: F-O-R-G-E: Forum On Resource Geostrategic Engagement

F = Forum; O = on (linking word in the full name); R = Resource; G = Geostrategic; E = Engagement

Mind-map outline

Economy, Science, Defence and Space

- Economy
 - 10-year bond yield 6.77%
 - One State One RRB policy
 - Digital rupee: e-W and e-R
- Science
 - BIRAC RDI Fund: 6 years
 - Supports TRL 4 and above
- Defence
 - DAC approvals: Rafale, P-81
 - CTF-154 command for India
 - Combined Maritime Forces: 47 nations
- Space and minerals
 - National Large Solar Telescope: Merak
 - National Large Optical Telescope: Hanle
 - US FORGE initiative

AILET Corner

Current Affairs February 2026: Defence, Security, Transport, Space and Institutions

Defence Technology and Missiles

The booklet covers a missile test of Agni-III, the Kaveri Engine Programme for military aviation, and the World Defence Show 2026. Agni-III is described with its range, propulsion and payload, while the Kaveri programme is tied to Aatmanirbhar Bharat. The World Defence Show is presented as a biennial global exhibition.

- Agni-III was successfully tested from Odisha.
- Agni-III is an intermediate-range ballistic missile.
- Agni-III is a two-stage solid-fuel missile system.
- Agni-III range is beyond 3000 km.
- Agni-III payload capability covers conventional and nuclear warheads.
- Agni-III was designed and developed by DRDO.
- Kaveri Engine Programme progress was reviewed at the Gas Turbine Research Establishment.
- Kaveri is an indigenous jet engine programme for fighter aircraft (LCA Tejas).
- World Defence Show 2026 was held in Riyadh, Saudi Arabia; it is biennial and organised by GAMI.

Mind-map outline

Defence technology and missiles

- Agni-III missile
 - Tested from Odisha
 - Range beyond 3000 km
 - Two-stage solid-fuel system
- Kaveri Engine Programme
 - Indigenous jet engine
 - Fighter aircraft (LCA Tejas)
- World Defence Show 2026
 - Biennial, organised by GAMI
 - Five domains: Air, Land, Sea, Space, Security

Global Security and Maritime Forums

NATO launched the Arctic Sentry mission to strengthen its presence in the Arctic, led by JFC Norfolk. The Indian Ocean Naval Symposium is a voluntary forum of Indian Ocean navies that India now chairs. The UN Office for Disarmament Affairs works on disarmament, and the Indian Army hosted one of its small arms training programmes.

- NATO launched the Arctic Sentry mission to enhance security presence in the Arctic region.
- Arctic Sentry is led by Joint Force Command Norfolk (JFC Norfolk).
- JFC Norfolk acts as a strategic bridge between North America and Europe for NATO operations.
- Arctic Sentry aims to safeguard NATO member states, protect territorial integrity and maintain regional stability.
- The mission responds to Russian military activity and China's growing interest in the Arctic.
- Competition over Arctic shipping routes and natural resources is emerging.
- Indian Ocean Naval Symposium was established in 2008 and initiated by the Indian Navy.
- IONS is a voluntary and inclusive multilateral forum of navies of the Indian Ocean Region.
- India assumed the chairmanship of the Indian Ocean Naval Symposium.
- UN Office for Disarmament Affairs was established in 1998 by the UN Secretary-General and is headquartered in New York.
- Core objective of the UN Office for Disarmament Affairs is complete elimination of weapons of mass destruction.

Mind-map outline

Global security and maritime forums

- Arctic Sentry (NATO)
 - Led by JFC Norfolk
 - Protect territorial integrity
- Indian Ocean Naval Symposium
 - Established 2008
 - Initiated by Indian Navy
- UN Office for Disarmament Affairs
 - Established 1998
 - HQ New York

Transport and Connectivity

Kavach is India's indigenous automated train protection system, developed by RDSO and deployed across more than 2200 route km. The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs approved an underwater twin tube road-cum-rail tunnel under the Brahmaputra in Assam to boost North-East connectivity. The tunnel links Gohpur on NH-15 with Numaligarh on NH-715.

- Kavach is India's Indigenous Automated Train Protection System.
- Kavach is deployed across over 2200 route km in India.
- Kavach objectives: prevent train collisions, avoid signal passing at danger, enhance situational awareness for loco pilots.
- Kavach was developed by RDSO (Indian Railways).
- The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs approved an underwater twin tube road-cum-rail tunnel to boost North-East connectivity.
- The tunnel is located under the Brahmaputra River in Assam.
- Total tunnel project length is 33.7 km; the underwater twin tube tunnel is 15.79 km.
- The tunnel connects Gohpur (NH-15) with Numaligarh (NH-715).

Mnemonic - Kavach objectives: Please Avoid Signals

P = Prevent train collisions; A = Avoid signal passing at danger; S = Situational awareness for loco pilots

Mind-map outline

Transport and connectivity

- Kavach
 - Prevent train collisions
 - Deployed over 2200 route km
- Brahmaputra twin tube tunnel
 - Connects Gohpur and Numaligarh
 - Underwater length 15.79 km

Space and Cyber Security

NASA's MESSENGER data revealed bright streaks across Mercury's surface, and the booklet gives key facts about the planet. The Global CyberPeace Summit 2026 was held in New Delhi.

- NASA's MESSENGER data revealed numerous bright streaks scattered across Mercury's surface.
- Mercury is the closest planet to the Sun and the smallest planet in the Solar System.
- Mercury is the fastest orbiting planet around the Sun.
- Mercury is the densest planet after Earth and has no moons or rings.
- Key Mercury discoveries: water ice in permanently shadowed polar craters and a large, iron-rich core.
- Global CyberPeace Summit 2026 concluded in New Delhi, organised by CyberPeace.
- Global Quantum Threat Alliance addresses future cyber risks arising from quantum computing.
- CoE on Automotive Cybersecurity focuses on securing connected, autonomous and electric vehicles.

Mnemonic - Mercury facts: Clever Snakes Fear Dogs

C = Closest planet to the Sun; S = Smallest planet in the Solar System; F = Fastest orbiting planet around the Sun; D = Densest planet after Earth

Mind-map outline

Space and cyber security

- Mercury
 - Closest planet to the Sun
 - Densest planet after Earth
 - Iron-rich core
- MESSENGER (NASA)
 - Bright streaks on Mercury
- Cyber initiatives
 - CyberPeace Summit 2026, New Delhi
 - Quantum Threat Alliance

Institutions and Places in News

The Indian Pharmacopoeia Commission, established in 2005, sets quality standards for medicines in India and signed three MoUs. APEDA marked 40 years of promoting agricultural exports, having been established in 1986. The Rafah Crossing in Gaza partially reopened after two years, allowing limited movement and humanitarian access.

- Indian Pharmacopoeia Commission signed 3 MoUs to strengthen medicine safety, quality and pharmacovigilance.
- The Pharmacopoeia is a legally binding compendium defining standards for identity, purity, strength and quality of medicines.
- Indian Pharmacopoeia Commission was established in 2005 and is headquartered in Ghaziabad (Uttar Pradesh).
- Indian Pharmacopoeia Commission is under the Ministry of Health & Family Welfare.
- Key publications: Indian Pharmacopoeia and National Formulary of India.
- APEDA marked 40 years of promoting India's agricultural exports; it was established in 1986.
- APEDA is a statutory body under the APEDA Act 1985 and operates under the Ministry of Commerce and Industry.
- APEDA headquarters is in New Delhi.
- Rafah Crossing in Gaza was partially reopened after two years, allowing limited movement and humanitarian access.

Mind-map outline

Institutions and places in news

- Indian Pharmacopoeia Commission
 - Established 2005
 - Signed 3 MoUs
- APEDA
 - Established 1986
 - Under Ministry of Commerce and Industry
- Rafah Crossing
 - Partially reopened after two years